



CONTROLLED ENTERPRISE DOCUMENT

MH Sales Estimating Guide

MH Construction, INC Enterprise Management System

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Use only after required functional, technical, field-usability, and approval gates are complete.

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MH Construction, INC Sales and Estimating Guide

Qualification, pursuit, estimating, proposal, contract and handoff controls

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This manual is an authoritative component of the MH Construction, INC Enterprise Management System. Employees follow this manual together with executed contracts, project-specific plans, jurisdiction addenda, manufacturer instructions and engineered requirements. Conflicts are stopped and escalated through the stated command path before work continues.

Sales and estimating controls

Required pursuit decisions

Every material opportunity receives a proportionate Go, Conditional Go, Hold or No-Go decision. Conditions have owners and close before submission or receive a documented exception.

Estimate independent review

An independent reviewer verifies current drawings/specifications/addenda, scope completeness, quantity/rate math, trade quote leveling, exclusions, schedule/general conditions, insurance/bonding/tax/permit costs, escalation, logistics, safety, quality and proposal risk language.

Proposal and contract authority

Only authorized personnel submit proposals or accept commercial commitments. High-risk contract exceptions are routed to qualified construction counsel or the applicable professional. Verbal clarifications affecting scope, cost, schedule or risk are confirmed in writing.

Accepted handoff

Operations handoff is complete only when the receiving PM accepts the executed contract/proposal reconciliation, estimate basis, scope map, commitments, client strategy, notices, schedule assumptions, procurement risks, safety/quality requirements and open decisions.

Operating procedures

SE-01.0 | Canonical Strategy Sources

The following sources govern all sales and estimating decisions. Treat the marketing parameters directory as the shared baseline cluster whenever sales or estimating communication crosses into marketing, public narrative, or reusable stakeholder-facing recap content.

Source	What It Controls	Use It For
Business Services (business/services.md)	Canonical service descriptions and proposal language	Service framing, scope language, and Client Partner-facing positioning
Marketing Strategy Guide	Public narrative and relationship-first messaging	Keeping public project narratives consistent with pursuit messaging
Social Media Branding Parameters	Shared campaign parameters baseline	Proof rules, lifecycle naming, message stack, and stakeholder-safe follow-up language
Proof and Approval Parameters	Shared evidence and release baseline	Verifying recap content, follow-up language, and reusable updates before external use
Pursuit and Handoff Parameters	Shared continuity and approval baseline	Opportunity-fit rules, approval authority, and pursuit-to-operations continuity
Brand Constants	Canonical brand values and factual framing	Title treatment, tone, and approved trust language
Dual Terminology Standard	Enterprise naming rules for outside audiences	Stakeholder-facing terms, role labels, and naming consistency
Universal Page Flow Standard	Lead-path page structure	Proposal and sales-page sequencing that moves from trust to action
Procore	Project management and RFI/RFQ documentation	Tracking awarded project scope, RFIs, and subcontract records
Sage 100	ERP and accounting	Cost code tracking, budget-to-actual, and financial reporting
BidPilot	Lead pipeline and client relationship management	Tracking pursuit status, logging contacts, and managing follow-up sequences

SE-02.0 | Core Doctrine and Operating Model

The CHNAV (Chief Navigation Officer) directs the department. The CHNAV bridges the gap between the Sales Commander and the Senior Estimator by ensuring the Sales Strategy is followed. The Sales Commander develops relationships and qualified bid opportunities with banks, architects, engineers and other client partners. The Senior Estimator develops the estimate and proposal basis.

Sales and estimating at MH Construction, INC exists to qualify the right work, define scope with discipline, and deliver proposals that operations can execute without ambiguity. The operating model is anchored by: Ground Truth Estimating: use validated site conditions, documented assumptions, and current stakeholder input, not optimism.

Zero-Gap Accountability: make sure the field reality, estimate structure, and Client Partner expectation all agree before the contract is signed.

Handshake Pride: build relationships around trust, transparency, and verified performance.

Mission-Ready Handoff: package the awarded work so project management inherits clear scope, clean assumptions, and an understandable decision trail.

These principles should lead to the MH end state: trust. Proposal language should favor clear scope, accountable delivery, dependable follow-through, and honest risk communication over aggressive sales language.

SE-03.0 | Command Controls and Approval Matrix

To protect the enterprise from financial exposure, all estimates, proposals, and post-contract change orders must follow the approval matrix before being presented to a Client Partner. The canonical approval authority baseline lives in the Pursuit and Handoff Parameters.

Section 3.1: Pre-Award Proposal Approval

Value	Required Approval Authority
Under \$25,000	Project Manager (Alpha, Bravo, or Charlie Wing)
\$25,000 to \$50,000	Chief Operating Officer (COO)
Over \$50,000	CEO

Section 3.2: Post-Award Change Order Approval

Change orders issued after contract execution follow the same value thresholds as pre-award proposals. The PM documents the change order in Procore, routes it through the approval matrix, and obtains Client Partner written acceptance before any additional scope work begins. No verbal change orders are binding.

Change Order Value	Required Approval Authority	Documentation Required
Under \$25,000	PM approval	Procore controlled record + Client Partner written acceptance
\$25,000 to \$50,000	COO approval	Procore controlled record + COO sign-off + Client Partner written acceptance
Over \$50,000	CEO approval	Procore controlled record + CEO sign-off + Client Partner written acceptance

Section 3.3: RFI and RFQ Response Authority

Responses to formal RFIs (Requests for Information) and RFQs (Requests for Qualifications) from public agencies or institutional clients require CEO review before submission. The CHNAV coordinates the response package and routes it through the CEO at least 48 hours before the submission deadline.

SE-04.0 | The 6-Step Preconstruction Workflow

These six steps define how MH moves from a real opportunity to a proposal that can be defended internally and executed cleanly in the field.

Section 4.1: Opportunity Qualification

Confirm the Client Partner relationship is real and reachable.

Determine whether the project fits MH capacity, schedule, geography, and service mix.

Apply the Bid/No-Bid Decision Framework (SE 07) before committing estimating resources.

Identify who holds decision authority and who is influencing the decision.

Stop early when the fit, timing, or access to decision-makers is not strong enough to support a credible pursuit.

Log the opportunity in BidPilot with source tag and initial qualification notes.

Section 4.2: Mission Parameters and Scope

Replace generic scope language with explicit Mission Parameters.

Define inclusions, exclusions, assumptions, clarifications, allowances, and alternates.

Request site verification, spatial capture, or additional design input when site conditions are not yet clear.

Tie every major assumption back to a visible project condition or known requirement.

Write the scope so leadership, operations, and the owner can all understand where responsibility begins and ends.

Section 4.3: Trade Partner Qualification

Vet Trade Partners for safety records, financial stability, capacity, and values alignment.

Verify current insurance certificates (GL, Workers Comp, Auto) and confirm MH Construction, INC is listed as additional insured.

Confirm Trade Partner holds all required state licenses for the project jurisdiction (WA, OR, or ID).

Make sure each Trade Partner understands the MHC safety, quality, and communication standard before contracting begins.

Use the referral and qualification process to protect both schedule and reputation.

Favor Trade Partners who strengthen accountability, communicate clearly, and can support the pace and standard of the work.

Section 4.4: Estimate Development Standard

Build the estimate in a disciplined format using approved cost logic and supporting assumptions.

Include labor, materials, equipment, safety overhead, and marketing-related cost codes where applicable.

Include a contingency line item. Standard contingency is 5-10% of direct costs; document the basis for the selected percentage.

Include an escalation clause for projects with a construction period exceeding 12 months or with significant material price exposure.

Keep the estimate transparent enough that leadership can explain it later without guesswork.

If a number cannot be defended with visible logic, revise it before it reaches leadership or the owner.

Section 4.5: Proposal Presentation

Keep proposals clean, professional, and easy to review.

Use plain language that explains value and risk clearly.

Define the Rules of Engagement, scope clarifications, and any conditions that affect the offer.

Present the proposal as a partnership rather than a transaction.

Make it easy for the owner to understand what is included, what is excluded, and what decisions still need to be made.

Include MH Construction, INC's WA, OR, and ID license numbers on all formal proposals.

Section 4.6: Operations Brief and Handoff

Lead the formal operations brief upon award.

Transfer Mission Parameters, Ground Truth intelligence, and approved assumptions to the COO and the project management teams.

Coordinate the handoff with marketing (CHENG) so public narrative and stakeholder communications remain aligned. See MG 09 for the marketing trigger protocol.

Treat the handoff as a continuity event, not an administrative file transfer.

Update the project record in Procore and BidPilot to reflect awarded status within two business days of contract execution.

SE-05.0 | Trade Partner Relations

The sales team is often the first point of contact for local specialized Trade Partners. In branded communications, use the approved terms Trade Partner or Sub-Operator. Reserve the term subcontractor for legal and regulatory contexts when required.

Section 5.1: Relationship Standard

Treat Trade Partners with the same respect as Client Partners.

Communicate clearly that working with MH means adhering to a disciplined, safety-first standard.

Keep the relationship aligned with the same evidence-backed posture expected in Client Partner-facing work.

Protect the relationship with timely answers, honest feedback, and clean documentation.

Section 5.2: Trade Partner Onboarding Requirements

Before a Trade Partner may begin work on any MH Construction, INC project, the following must be on file:

Requirement	Verification Method	Owner
Current Certificate of Insurance (GL, WC, Auto)	COI on file, MH listed as additional insured	CHNAV / PM
State contractor license (applicable jurisdiction)	License number verified on state database	CHNAV
Signed MH Construction, INC Trade Partner Agreement	Executed contract on file in Procore	CHNAV / PM
MISH safety orientation acknowledgment	Signed form on file in Procore	Site Safety Commander
W-9 on file	Sage 100 vendor record	Accounting

SE-06.0 | Proposal and Follow-Up Workflow

A proposal should not only be turned in on time. It should leave a clean record of what was offered, why it was priced that way, and how the relationship should continue after submission.

1. Confirm the due date, submission format, review path, and owner responsibilities.
2. Gather the latest documents, addenda, stakeholder notes, and open questions.
3. Align the estimator lead, leadership review, and specialty inputs before finalization.
4. Deliver the proposal on time and with clear clarifications.
5. Record the outcome in BidPilot and Procore. Capture lessons using the Lost-Bid Debrief format (below) for all no-award outcomes.
6. If follow-up language, recap assets, or owner-approved updates may be repurposed externally, align them with the shared parameters baselines before release.

Section 6.1: Lost-Bid Debrief Format

For every pursuit that does not result in an award, the CHNAV completes a brief debrief record in BidPilot within 10 business days of the no-award notification. The debrief captures:

Project name, value, and client type.

Bid/no-bid score at time of qualification (from SE 07).

Estimated vs. awarded value (if known).

Primary reason for loss (price, relationship, scope gap, timing, other).

Lessons learned and recommended adjustments for future similar pursuits.

Debrief data is reviewed quarterly by the CEO and CHNAV to refine the qualification criteria and estimating standards.

SE-07.0 | Bid / No-Bid Decision Framework

Before committing estimating resources to any pursuit, the CHNAV completes a Bid/No-Bid score. A score below 60 requires COO review before proceeding. A score below 40 is a no-bid unless the CEO overrides.

Criterion	Weight	Score 1-5 (5 = Strong Fit)	Notes
Client Partner relationship quality	20%	Enter 1-5	Known client, referral, or new cold contact
Project type / service mix fit	15%	Enter 1-5	Within MH core services or adjacent
Geography and logistics	10%	Enter 1-5	WA/OR/ID coverage; travel and mobilization cost
Schedule fit with current backlog	15%	Enter 1-5	Can MH staff and execute without overcommitting
Margin potential	20%	Enter 1-5	Estimated GP% vs. MH target margin
Risk profile	10%	Enter 1-5	Site conditions, design completeness, owner track record
Strategic value	10%	Enter 1-5	Reference project, new market, repeat client potential

Weighted score = sum of (score x weight). Maximum score = 5.0. Threshold: 3.0+ = proceed; 2.0-2.9 = COO review; below 2.0 = no-bid unless CEO overrides.

SE-08.0 | Bonding, Licensing, and Multi-State Controls

Public and institutional projects frequently require performance and payment bonds. The CHNAV is responsible for confirming bonding capacity before submitting a proposal on any public project or any project where bonding is specified.

Section 8.1: Bonding

Confirm current bonding capacity with the surety agent before pursuing any bonded project.

Include bonding cost in the estimate as a direct cost line item.

Do not submit a bonded proposal without CEO confirmation that capacity is available.

Maintain current financial statements and work-in-progress schedules as required by the surety.

Section 8.2: Licensing

MH Construction, INC holds active licenses in Washington (MHCONCI907R7), Oregon (194331), and Idaho (RCE-49250). All proposals must include the applicable license number for the project jurisdiction. Proposals for projects in jurisdictions where MH does not hold a license require CEO approval and a licensing plan before submission.

Section 8.3: Multi-State Proposal Differences

Oregon and Idaho have different prevailing wage, lien, and contractor registration requirements from Washington. The CHNAV confirms state-specific requirements before finalizing any out-of-state proposal. Scope exclusion language and payment terms may need to be adjusted for Oregon and Idaho projects.

SE-09.0 | Guardrails

Do not blur marketing promises into estimating commitments.

Do not provide a number without enough project definition to support it.

Do not misrepresent capability, availability, or scope coverage.

Keep private pricing conversations and public messaging separated.

Preserve MH naming, trust references, and veteran-owned factual framing.

Avoid internal jargon, inflated certainty, and pursuit language that hides real scope risk from the owner.

When sales content is likely to be reused by marketing, verify it still meets the shared parameters baselines for proof, tone, lifecycle terminology, and release readiness.

Do not submit a proposal without completing the Bid/No-Bid score (SE 07).

Do not execute a change order without Client Partner written acceptance on file.

SE-10.0 | Success Measures and Pipeline Reporting

Track the strategy at four levels so performance is measured on fit, estimate discipline, stakeholder confidence, and handoff quality. The CHNAV reports pipeline metrics to the CEO monthly.

Measure	What Good Looks Like	Reporting Cadence	Owner
Qualified pipeline	Opportunities fit MH and are worth the estimating effort	Weekly pipeline review	CHNAV
Estimate quality	Numbers are supportable, repeatable, and explained clearly	Per-proposal review	CHNAV
Stakeholder trust	Bankers, architects, city officials, and Client Partners get timely, credible responses	Monthly CEO report	CHNAV
Handoff quality	Awarded work moves to operations without scope confusion	Per-project post-award review	CHNAV / COO
Win rate	Percentage of qualified pursuits resulting in award	Monthly (BidPilot)	CHNAV
Bid/no-bid accuracy	No-bid decisions are validated by lost-bid debrief data	Quarterly review	CHNAV / CEO
Change order rate	Change orders as % of original contract value	Per-project closeout	PM / CHNAV

SE-11.0 | Mobilization / Project Start and Review

Before using a new sales or estimating run, confirm the following so the pursuit stays aligned with MH brand standards and delivery reality:

7. The opportunity was qualified against the current fit criteria and Bid/No-Bid score.
8. The estimate reflects the latest scope and stakeholder decisions.
9. The proposal language matches the approved MH brand and terminology rules.
10. The follow-up plan is documented so the relationship does not stall after submission.
11. Trade Partner onboarding requirements (SE 05.2) are confirmed before award.
12. Bonding and licensing requirements (SE 08) are confirmed for public or out-of-state projects.
13. The guide output is regenerated after material changes to the strategy or section structure.

Related Canonical Sources

Sales Documentation Index - broader sales and estimating references.

Brand Constants - canonical company facts, slogan standards, and approved trust language.

Dual Terminology Standard - stakeholder-safe naming rules for roles, labels, and enterprise terminology.

Business Services - service descriptions and Client Partner-facing capability framing.

Social Media Branding Parameters - shared campaign parameters baseline.

Lifecycle Campaign Parameters - shared phase naming, week ranges, and campaign-stage language.

Proof and Approval Parameters - shared evidence gates, approval checks, and hold conditions.

Pursuit and Handoff Parameters - shared opportunity-fit rules, approval authority, and handoff continuity baseline.

Marketing Strategy Guide - alignment point for public narrative, relationship language, and post-award communications.

Procore - project management, RFI/RFQ, and subcontract records.

Sage 100 - ERP, cost codes, and financial reporting.

BidPilot - lead pipeline, attribution, and follow-up management.

SE-12.0: Client Communication & Stakeholder Standards

12.1 Strategic Intent

The core MH Construction, INC promise is 'Building projects for the client, NOT the dollar.' This philosophy is operationalized through our communication standards. The Sales Commander and PM Wings must ensure that owners, architects, and engineers are treated as active partners, not adversaries, throughout the project lifecycle.

12.2 Communication Cadence

Proactive communication prevents adversarial relationships. The following cadence is mandatory for all active projects:

- **Weekly Updates:** The Project Manager must provide a brief weekly update to the client/owner's rep detailing progress, upcoming milestones, and any immediate roadblocks. This is logged in Procore.
- **Monthly Progress Meetings:** Formal OAC (Owner, Architect, Contractor) meetings must be held monthly to review schedule, budget, and RFI status.

12.3 RFI and Change Order Transparency

All RFIs and Change Orders must be submitted through Procore with complete context. The Senior Estimator and PM must ensure that cost impacts are clearly justified. We do not hide costs or ambush clients with unexpected change orders at the end of a project. If a change is necessary, it is communicated immediately.

12.4 Handshake Protocol

Despite our reliance on digital infrastructure (Procore, High-Level), the 'digital handshake' must reflect the integrity of a physical one. The Sales Commander is responsible for maintaining the personal relationship with the client even after the project is handed off to the PM Wing.

DIRECTIVE - Sales Standard

GENERAL ORDER - Procedure

FIELD INSTRUCTION - Execution

SE-13.0 | Digital Handshake and CRM Governance

DIRECTIVE: SE-13-DIR-01: Purpose. The "digital handshake" is the operational standard for client relationship management at MH Construction, INC. It ensures that the integrity of a physical handshake is maintained throughout the digital lifecycle of a project. BidPilot is the canonical system of record for all pre-award relationship data.

GENERAL ORDER: SE-13-GO-01: BidPilot Mandate. All inbound leads, opportunity qualifications, and client communications prior to contract execution must be logged in BidPilot. The CHNAV is responsible for ensuring pipeline accuracy and lead attribution.

GENERAL ORDER: SE-13-GO-02: The 24-Hour Rule. All client inquiries (phone, email, web form) must receive a substantive response within 24 hours. If an estimate or RFI answer is not ready, a status update must be provided.

FIELD INSTRUCTION: SE-13-FI-01: CRM Logging. After every significant client interaction (site walk, proposal review, scope clarification), the Sales Commander or CHNAV must log a brief summary in the BidPilot contact record.